

THE VIKING LONGSHIP

The Vikings who stormed Lindisfarne sailed hundreds of miles west over the North Sea from their home in Scandinavia. As well as being great warriors, they are brilliant sailors and master shipbuilders. These skills mean they can travel great distances over rough seas.



Battleaxe

The ax was a fearsome weapon, with its sharp, curved blade and long handle, perfect for two-handed blows.

Helmet
Helmets were made from iron, often with a visor and nose guard to protect the eyes and face. The inside was padded with cloth, and leather straps underneath kept the helmet in place.



Protective dragons

Dragons were powerful symbols to the Vikings. This metal pin shows the head of the dragon Nidhogg who, in Viking mythology, is nibbling away at the roots of Yggdrasil, the Tree of Life, where gods, humans, and giants all live.

The dragon figurehead is intended to ward off evil spirits and scare enemies.

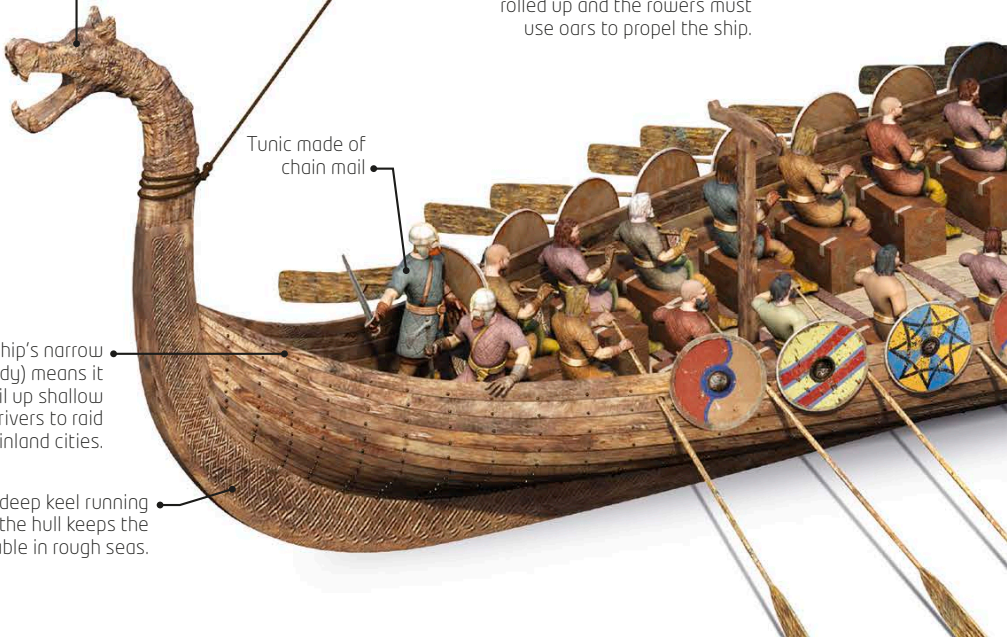


The sail is only used when it is windy. In calm weather, it is rolled up and the rowers must use oars to propel the ship.



Part-time warriors

The Vikings who attacked Lindisfarne were not full-time soldiers—many who joined the raiding party were farmers or fishermen. They wore metal armor if they could afford it—if not, they wore tunics of padded leather.



Tunic made of chain mail

The ship's narrow hull (body) means it can sail up shallow rivers to raid inland cities.

The deep keel running under the hull keeps the ship stable in rough seas.